

# World Views and Aspirations of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit Communities in Canada, Grade 11

College Preparation (NBV3C)

Workplace Preparation (NBV3E)

## OVERVIEW

“World Views and Aspirations of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit Communities in Canada” provides an opportunity for students to explore Indigenous beliefs, values, and ways of knowing, as reflected in the historical and contemporary experiences of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit in Canada. By gaining an understanding of the ways in which First Nations, Métis and Inuit histories, values, perspectives, traditions, and aspirations differ from those of non-Indigenous Canadians, students develop the ability to analyse and compare world views. They learn that understanding cultural diversity and differences in world views is a key component of cultural harmony and respectful relationships between First Nations, Métis, and Inuit and non-Indigenous Canadians. Students also reflect on how their personal world view affects how they interpret and interact with the world around them.

This course examines critical issues facing First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals and communities. By exploring past and present aspects of colonialism, as well as the effect of government policies and actions on First Nations, Métis, and Inuit, students advance their understanding of the ongoing struggle for decolonization and of the resiliency of Indigenous peoples in Canada. This knowledge and insight enables students to become critically thoughtful and informed citizens who can help promote reconciliation in Canada.

## STRANDS

This course has four strands. Strand A, Research and Inquiry Skills, is followed by three content strands, which are organized thematically. Although strand A is presented separately from the areas of learning presented in strands B–D, teachers should ensure that students develop their research and inquiry skills in appropriate ways as they work to achieve the curriculum expectations in the other strands of the course.

## A. Research and Inquiry Skills

Strand A focuses on developing students' ability to apply the inquiry process to investigate the beliefs and historical and contemporary experiences of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit in Canada. Students gather, interpret, and analyse evidence and information from a variety of primary and secondary sources, including Indigenous knowledge sources; synthesize their findings and formulate conclusions; and communicate the results of their research. This process and related skills apply to, and should be developed in conjunction with, the content of all the other strands of the course. Educators are encouraged to refer to the general discussion of the research and inquiry process that appears in the introduction to this document (see [page 24](#)) for necessary information relating to all First Nations, Métis, and Inuit studies courses.

## B. Understanding and Respecting World Views and Cultural Diversity

In strand B, students explore the concept of world view and the role of a world view, or belief system, in daily life. By examining the elements, purposes, and functions of a world view in the context of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, students learn to identify distinct and common elements and develop their appreciation of both cultural uniqueness and shared humanity. Students deepen their understanding of how language, culture, and the relationship between people and place shape and reflect First Nations, Métis, and Inuit world views, identifying key elements of the beliefs, values, and customs of diverse cultural groups. Students gain an understanding of and respect for the diversity of cultural protocols, traditional values, and belief systems. Students also learn to use cultural awareness skills and strategies appropriately when exploring First Nations, Métis, and Inuit ways of knowing, world views, and contributions to society.

## C. Colonization and Decolonization

In strand C, students develop their understanding of the concept of colonialism and of the past and present impact of colonization and associated government policies in Canada, gaining an understanding of how relations between Indigenous and non-Indigenous peoples relate to current realities. Students think critically and creatively about issues of concern to Indigenous peoples and examine key concepts and goals related to decolonization and resilience. Students analyse various strategies to raise awareness of the impact of colonialist policies and to sustain First Nations, Métis, and Inuit world views, aspirations, and actions in the context of social change.

## D. Reclamation and Reconciliation

Strand D focuses on the importance of building respectful and reciprocal relationships to support reconciliation between Indigenous peoples and Canadian society. By learning about how individuals, families, institutions, and communities are reclaiming a place for First Nations, Métis, and Inuit beliefs, values, and customs in contemporary life, students deepen their understanding of the critical importance of recognition and respect for First Nations, Métis, and Inuit knowledge, world views, and aspirations. Recognition and respect are the foundations of truth, reconciliation, and renewed nation-to-nation relationships. Students also examine how key First Nations, Métis, and Inuit aspirations for communities, for Canada, and for global society reflect traditional and contemporary beliefs and values, and analyse the role of social action in supporting those goals.

# World Views and Aspirations of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit Communities in Canada, Grade 11

College Preparation

NBV3C

This course explores the diverse knowledge, world views, and aspirations that shape the actions of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals and communities in Canada. Students will examine the historical and contemporary context of those beliefs, values, aspirations, and actions, including the impact of colonization and decolonization. Students will explore the factors that shape world views to develop an understanding of how acknowledging diverse cultures, values, and ways of knowing contributes to truth, reconciliation, and renewed nation-to-nation relationships. Students are also given the opportunity to develop their own problem-solving strategies to build mutual understanding related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit world views and aspirations.

**Prerequisite:** First Nations, Métis, and Inuit in Canada, Grade 10, Open, or Canadian History since World War I, Grade 10, Academic or Applied

# A. RESEARCH AND INQUIRY SKILLS

## OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

Throughout this course, students will:

- A1. Exploring:** explore topics related to the knowledge, world views, and aspirations that shape the actions of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals and communities, identifying key concepts and formulating critical questions to guide their research and inquiry;
- A2. Investigating:** create research plans, and locate and select information relevant to their chosen topics from a variety of sources, using appropriate research and inquiry methods and respecting Indigenous knowledge and ways of knowing;
- A3. Processing Information:** assess, record, analyse, and synthesize information gathered through research and inquiry, respecting Indigenous knowledge and ways of knowing;
- A4. Communicating and Reflecting:** communicate the results of their research and inquiry clearly and effectively, and reflect on and evaluate their research, inquiry, and communication skills.

## SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

### A1. Exploring

Throughout this course, students will:

- A1.1** explore a variety of themes related to the knowledge, world views, and aspirations that shape the actions of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals and communities (*e.g., the changing relationship between nature and humanity; the role of Indigenous ecological knowledge, or IEK, in environmental initiatives; the significance of Aboriginal title for land use and resource management in Canada; First Nations, Métis, and Inuit approaches to equity and gendered social roles; the purpose and processes of restorative justice; forms of First Nations, Métis, and/or Inuit community governance*) to identify topics for research and inquiry

- A1.2** identify key concepts related to their selected topics (*e.g., through listening, discussion, brainstorming, the use of visual organizers*)

**Sample questions:** “How do First Nations, Métis, and Inuit characterize an individual’s responsibility to the land, the people, and the community? What key concept does this perspective express?” “How is contemporary science beginning to draw on First Nations and Inuit knowledge? What ecological concepts are being taken into account?” “What type of visual organizer might help you identify economic

distinctions between First Nations, Métis, and/or Inuit communities in different regions of Canada? How might your topic be connected to the concept of social justice?”

- A1.3** formulate effective questions to guide their research and inquiry

**Sample questions:** “What questions might guide your research if you were exploring the role of First Nations, Métis, or Inuit beliefs and value systems in health care? Why might it be important to consider how these beliefs and value systems may have changed over time?” “How might you change the questions you have developed to narrow the focus of your research?”

### A2. Investigating

Throughout this course, students will:

- A2.1** create appropriate research plans to investigate their selected topics (*e.g., outline purpose and method; identify sources of information; develop research tools such as surveys, questionnaires, or interviews*), ensuring that their plans apply the principles of intent, reciprocity, and respect and that they acknowledge Indigenous ways of knowing and related protocols (*e.g., intent: clearly articulate the motivation for and purpose*

of the project; assess the consequences of the investigation for ancestors, future generations, and/or the natural world; reciprocity: plan to share the process and results of their investigation at all stages, to give and receive information, and to listen to and speak with those who may be affected by the work; engage in sustained mutual relationship building; respect: explain how they will acknowledge the connections between the human, natural, physical, spiritual, cultural, economic, and/or emotional contexts of the topic; identify which types of knowledge can or cannot be shared and seek informed consent from Indigenous individuals and/or communities when necessary)

**Sample questions:** “What is the purpose of your investigation? How is your inquiry beneficial to First Nations, Métis, or Inuit individuals and/or communities?” “What steps can you take to ensure that the community and/or individuals you learned from have given you informed consent to record and share the information?” “What is sacred or protected knowledge? Why might individuals and/or a community choose not to share this information with researchers or individuals who are not part of the community?” “How might you demonstrate reciprocity when you receive information from a community?”

**A2.2** locate and select information relevant to their investigations from a variety of primary and/or secondary sources, including Indigenous knowledge sources (e.g., primary sources: oral stories, histories, and lessons; original documents such as interview transcripts, letters, financial documents, logs and journals, surveys, questionnaires; literature; original media such as film, photographs, songs; published primary research such as data sets; secondary sources: history books, biographies, textbooks, book reviews, journal and magazine articles, essays, academic conference papers, summaries of court cases and/or legislation, documentaries, most websites)

**Sample questions:** “What is an Indigenous knowledge source, and how can it be used to pursue an investigation?” “How can you determine whether a source is primary or secondary?” “Why is it important to base your investigation on a variety of sources?” “How might you include Indigenous community-based knowledge in your investigation?”

**A2.3** based on preliminary research, formulate a hypothesis, thesis statement, or critical question for each investigation, and use it to focus their inquiry

## A3. Processing Information

Throughout this course, students will:

**A3.1** assess various aspects of information gathered from Indigenous and non-Indigenous knowledge sources, using general research criteria (e.g., accuracy, relevance, reliability, inherent values and bias, voice) and respecting Indigenous world views and ways of knowing (e.g., avoiding claims of universality, hierarchical knowledge, and/or exclusive authority; acknowledging social, historical, economic, and political context; demonstrating an understanding that the perspectives expressed in diverse knowledge sources are shaped by world views that may challenge one another)

**Sample questions:** “How can you determine whether all the information you have gathered is relevant to your topic?” “Whose perspectives are represented in this source, and whose are not?” “How do these sources about the consequences of the sled dog slaughter of the 1950s and ’60s for the Inuit way of life contradict each other? How might you determine which source is more reliable?” “How might you check whether this website contains credible information that represents Indigenous perspectives appropriately?”

**A3.2** record and organize information and key ideas using a variety of formats (e.g., notes, graphic organizers, summaries, audio/digital records, spreadsheets)

**A3.3** analyse and interpret research information (e.g., compare information provided in written documents, oral stories, and interviews; determine whether common themes arise in different sources)

**Sample questions:** “What patterns of information can you find in your research? How might you identify a common theme?”

**A3.4** demonstrate academic honesty by documenting the sources, including oral sources, of all information generated through research

**A3.5** synthesize findings and formulate conclusions (e.g., weigh and connect information to determine the answer to their research question; assess the extent to which their findings may be affected by factors not included in their research design; determine whether their results support or contradict their hypothesis)

**Sample questions:** “What connections did you find between the information you gathered about food safety on the Health Canada website and in Nunavut’s food safety guidelines, *Serving Country Food in Government-Funded Facilities*

and Community Programs? What do the Nunavut guidelines suggest about handling and serving the foods associated with a traditional Inuit diet? Why do these guidelines apply only in government-funded facilities and community programs? Does this information support or contradict your original research question about traditional diet?”

#### A4. Communicating and Reflecting

Throughout this course, students will:

**A4.1** use an appropriate format (e.g., *oral presentation, brochure, infographic, poster, multimedia work, written report, seminar, digital presentation, storytelling, podcast, blog entry, web page*) to communicate the results of their research and inquiry effectively for a specific purpose and audience

**A4.2** use correctly terms and phrases related to various First Nations, Métis, and Inuit world views and experiences (e.g., *ways of knowing, interconnectedness of all living things, historic Métis communities, Métis root ancestors, traditional territory, extended family, clan system, Indigenous language, storytelling, reciprocity, reconciliation, revitalization, self-determination, colonization and decolonization, restorative justice, ethnogenesis, treaty, trade agreement*)

**Sample questions:** “What does the term ‘traditional territory’ mean? Why do we acknowledge the traditional land on which we stand? How can this practice inform your research?” “What is distinctive about storytelling in First Nations, Métis, and Inuit contexts? What is the role of storytelling in the expression of diverse Indigenous world views?” “What is reconciliation, and how does it affect the process of building or changing relationships between Indigenous and non-Indigenous peoples?”

**A4.3** clearly communicate the results of their inquiries (e.g., *write coherently, organize ideas logically, use language conventions properly*), and follow documentation conventions for acknowledging sources (e.g., *generate a bibliography or a reference list in APA style, use footnotes or endnotes, include in-text author-date citations, provide a credits list for illustrative material*)

**A4.4** demonstrate an understanding of the general research and inquiry process by reflecting on and evaluating their own research, inquiry, and communication skills, while respecting Indigenous knowledge and ways of knowing

**Sample questions:** “In what ways did the information you gathered confirm what you already knew and understood about the topic? In what ways did the information you found provide you with new perspectives about what you thought was true? How do you explain this new understanding?” “In what ways did Indigenous knowledge help you interpret primary and secondary sources and give you a deeper understanding of the topic?”

## B. UNDERSTANDING AND RESPECTING WORLD VIEWS AND CULTURAL DIVERSITY

### OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1. The Concept of World View:** demonstrate an understanding of the elements, purposes, and functions of a world view or belief system, and explore the role of world view in daily life in Canada;
- B2. First Nations, Métis, and Inuit World Views:** demonstrate an understanding of how language, culture, and the relationship between people and place shape and reflect First Nations, Métis, and Inuit world views, identifying key elements of the beliefs, values, and customs associated with diverse cultures;
- B3. Cultural Awareness Skills and Strategies:** use cultural awareness skills and strategies appropriately when exploring First Nations, Métis, and Inuit ways of knowing, world views, and contributions to society.

### SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

#### B1. The Concept of World View

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1.1** identify and make connections between various elements of a world view or belief system (*e.g., beliefs about the existence of a deity or deities, shamanism, the origins of the universe and of humanity, the relationship between humanity and the natural world; family or kin relationships and responsibilities; concepts of time; rites of passage; expressions of gratitude; values governing human interaction; commitment to the transmission of knowledge from generation to generation; beliefs about fairness, economic justice, prosperity, and wealth*), suggesting some factors that shape world views

**Sample questions:** “What are some typical elements of a belief system?” “What connection can you make between how ‘family’ is defined within a world view and how the role of individuals within the community is understood?” “Do you think that concepts of time and rites of passage are related elements of a world view? Why, or why not? What distinguishes these elements?” “Thinking about how your own world view has changed over time, what factors can you identify that affect world view?” “How does world view inform conceptions of economic growth and prosperity?”

- B1.2** compare world views or belief systems associated with a few different cultures to identify common purposes and functions (*e.g., as a framework for thinking about the world, reality, and existence; as a set of principles on which to base decisions, aspirations, and actions; as the foundation of a sense of self and of individual and collective identity; as a guide to interactions and relationships with others*)

**Sample questions:** “What elements of your own world view are also found in the world view of another culture? What specific examples can you give?” “Why do you think that the belief systems of cultures around the world share common elements? What does that tell us about the purpose of a belief system?” “How might the elements of a world view that influence gender relationships differ from one culture to another? How might those differences influence behaviour?” “What are some ways in which your world view influences your behaviour in various social contexts?” “What evidence from different cultures can you find to demonstrate that world view influences economic policy making?”

- B1.3** explain how a variety of aspects of daily life and common aspirations in Canada are shaped by and reflect specific beliefs and values (*e.g., with reference to laws regarding property and*

private ownership, a judicial system based on written common or civil law, marriage laws and conventions, the provincial and federal administration of education, the practice of taxation), analysing how those beliefs and values may support or conflict with Indigenous world views

**Sample questions:** “How do First Nations, Métis, and Inuit beliefs about land ownership differ from beliefs about ownership that are supported by the Canadian federal government?” “What framework is the Canadian legal system founded upon? How does this framework differ from Indigenous beliefs about restorative justice? What are some ways in which these differences affect daily life and common aspirations in First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities?” “What common aspirations in Canadian society are also expressed in the Métis Nation of Ontario Statement of Prime Purpose? In what ways do contemporary economic aspirations in Canada conflict with Métis world views?”

## B2. First Nations, Métis, and Inuit World Views

By the end of this course, students will:

**B2.1** identify a variety of common elements of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit beliefs and customs (e.g., beliefs: *about creation, the stages of life, the sacredness of the land*; customs: *acknowledging traditional lands, smudging and/or kullik lighting, the use of traditional medicines, prayers, sunrise ceremonies, gift giving, ceremonial songs and dances*), and analyse the values reflected in these beliefs and customs (e.g., *with reference to environmental protection, intergenerational knowledge transmission, community relationships*)

**Sample questions:** “What are some common ways in which First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals give thanks to animals for providing them with sustenance? What values does this custom express?” “What does the concept of seven generations suggest about planning for the future? Which peoples share this concept?” “What are some ways in which First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals celebrate the transition from childhood to adulthood?” “What does the phrase ‘all my relations’ tell us about Anishinaabe and Cree world views? What other communities share this perspective?” “In what ways do Inuit maligait, or natural laws, govern human interactions with the environment? What values do these laws embody?” “How do Inuit welcome the return of light after a month of winter darkness? What beliefs and values does this custom reflect? What other culture or cultures have a similar custom?”

**B2.2** make and explain various connections between First Nations, Métis, and Inuit languages and world views (e.g., *Inuit in Canada use the Inuktitut term “Inuit Nunangat” for homeland, referring collectively to land, water, and ice and expressing the centrality of the waters in an Inuit world view, rather than the Greenlandic term “Inuit Nunaat”, referring only to land; Michif is derived from Cree and French but also draws on other First Nations languages, such as Ojibwe, and on English, reflecting the unique cultural heritage and cultural understanding of its speakers; the term “Turtle Island”, which is used by various First Nations to refer to the land known as North America, comes from a creation story and reveals the central role of animals in the spiritual beliefs and world views of many Indigenous cultures*), and suggest some ways in which the changing use of these languages affects individual and community identities

**Sample questions:** “What are some ways in which languages and language use change over time? How does that affect individuals, families, and communities?” “Why do you think various First Nations, Métis, and Inuit belief systems consider language, culture, and identity to be interconnected?” “Why does the Inuktitut term for homeland make no distinction between land, water, and ice? What does this reflect about an Inuit world view?” “What has your research revealed about the origins of the Michif language? How might that shape the world view of its speakers? How does the use of Michif sustain Métis cultural identity?”

**B2.3** analyse how a variety of significant figures associated with First Nations, Métis, and Inuit belief systems reflect, express, and/or support aspects of a world view (e.g., *Nanabush’s use of storytelling to teach the listener about the nature of existence demonstrates the central role of oral teaching in the Anishinaabe world view; in Inuit culture, the shaman dances, sings, chants, and plays drums to call upon the spirits of the deceased or people in faraway places, reflecting the interconnection of the human and spirit worlds; Ti-Jean uses his wits to outsmart his opponents and solve problems, illustrating the Métis values of perseverance and ingenuity*), and make inferences about the continuing relevance of these figures in contemporary life

**Sample questions:** “Why do some First Nations communities consider the eagle a significant symbol? How is the eagle connected to the world views of these communities? What contemporary observances attest to the continuing special bond between the people and the eagle?” “How is the Peacemaker important to Haudenosaunee beliefs about consensus?” “What moral lessons do Métis

stories about the Rougarou and Ti-Jean teach? What values and beliefs do they reflect? How are these still relevant for Métis individuals?"

- B2.4** analyse how a variety of locations that First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities consider culturally significant reflect aspects of a world view (e.g., *the belief of Curve Lake First Nation members that spirits speak through crevices in the Kinomaage-Waapkong, or Teaching Rocks, emphasizes the connection between the natural and spirit worlds; the belief that Inuit land at Marble Island, Nunavut, is not only a traditional hunting area but also the historical site of a creation story indicates that the land has lessons to teach the people; the continued significance of Mica Bay as the site of a confrontation between Métis land defenders and non-Indigenous miners reveals the role of history in shaping Métis identity*), and make inferences about the continuing relevance of these sites in contemporary life

**Sample questions:** "What value is associated with the belief that particular locations, such as Dreamer's Rock, are sites of spiritual direction? How is this value reflected in the fasting, visions, and sweat lodge ceremonies that are practised at such sites? In what ways do these ceremonies sustain individual and cultural identity in a contemporary world?" "What do the stories, knowledge, and traditions that are associated with the kettle stones found along the shore of Lake Huron tell us about the world view of the Kettle and Stony Point First Nation?" "What practice is associated with Inuit traditional land at Marble Island? What belief does that reflect?"

- B2.5** analyse and compare several different First Nations, Métis, and Inuit ceremonies and other traditional practices in terms of how these practices help define individual and/or collective roles and responsibilities within a world view (e.g., *with reference to rites of passage, seasonal practices, decision-making processes, governance*)

**Sample questions:** "How does the concept of Guswenta or Kaswentha (Two Row Wampum), influence the conduct of neighbouring nations during the Haudenosaunee Edge of the Woods ceremony? What other traditional practices have a similar purpose? How do these practices help shape contemporary Indigenous perspectives?" "How do Cree and Anishinaabe individuals use the medicine wheel to support decision making? In what ways does this practice help define the individual's responsibilities? What other First Nations decision-making practices can you identify?" "How do Inuit rites of passage build leadership skills and encourage pride in cultural identity? What examples can

you give? How might you compare these rites of passage to those in another Indigenous culture?" "How does the Teslin Tlingit Council incorporate traditional practices associated with the clan system into contemporary governance institutions?" "What traditional Métis practices are associated with marriage and birth, and how are these practices distinct from those of other cultures? What individual roles are connected with these practices, and with what responsibilities? How do these roles reflect Métis values?"

### B3. Cultural Awareness Skills and Strategies

By the end of this course, students will:

- B3.1** identify and explain the purpose of a variety of cultural awareness skills and strategies (e.g., *remaining open to a variety of world views in a group discussion deepens the cultural understanding of the participants; demonstrating an understanding of local community experiences when seeking information and knowledge indicates respect and empathy; researching the beliefs, values, and aspirations of other cultures before guest speaker presentations enables listeners to follow appropriate cultural protocols when asking questions and to extend their learning; identifying signs of social discomfort during peer interactions can help bridge cultural differences*), and apply them effectively when exploring First Nations, Métis, and Inuit ways of knowing, world views, and contributions to society

**Sample questions:** "How might knowledge of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit family structures and kinship systems support the development of Indigenous programming in public institutions? How might such knowledge be helpful to educational or health organizations that are establishing Indigenous community advisory councils?" "What are some ways to demonstrate respect for, and respond to, the perspectives of a First Nation, Métis, or Inuit community facing a complex issue?"

- B3.2** analyse several different First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultural works in terms of what they communicate about cultural identity, cultural continuity, and/or cross-cultural interaction (e.g., *assess Tomson Highway's play The Rez Sisters as a response to cultural stereotyping; analyse the juxtaposition of historical documents and images in the design of some Idle No More communications; compare First Nations community perspectives of the Mohawk Warrior Flag with its depiction in mainstream media, and suggest reasons for any differences*)

**Sample questions:** “What visual layers and/or narrative can you find in Jane Ash Poitras’s mixed-media work *Living in the Storm Too Long*? What is significant about the artist’s use of collage in this work?” “What connections does artist Barry Ace make in his mixed-media work *Erased* between historical and contemporary Indigenous realities? What message about cultural continuity do you think this work communicates?” “What does Kelly Duquette’s art communicate about Métis cultural identity? How is this similar to or different from themes in Christie Belcourt’s work?”

**B3.3** analyse a variety of policies regulating public institutions in Canada to identify how these policies have challenged and continue to challenge First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultural practices (e.g., *the school calendar does not always accommodate culturally significant practices, ceremonies, and special days; access to spiritual guidance, including from Elders, is not supported within some health and wellness programs; non-Indigenous approaches to health care may discourage an Inuk from carrying her baby in an amauti*), and suggest appropriate strategies to ensure that these institutions are inclusive (e.g., *gathering and analysing group feedback to determine how a school policy affects individual students’ cultural practices, and using the feedback to propose improvements to the policy; adapting the school calendar in some communities to allow Cree and Métis youth to participate in the hunting season; hiring Indigenous patient navigators to support First Nations, Inuit, and Métis individuals who are receiving treatment within the health care system; developing a community outreach program that supports Indigenous health care approaches*)

**Sample questions:** “Do you think the acceptance of diverse cultural practices in public settings has increased or decreased over the last generation? What evidence can you offer to support your opinion?” “How might public officials respond to a family’s request to engage in traditional practices at a hospital birth or to use traditional medicines when caring for a relative in a clinical setting?” “What is the main purpose of this policy on the school board website? How might you revise the text to maintain the intention of the policy while accommodating an Indigenous cultural practice? What benefits might that have for all students?”

**B3.4** identify an issue associated with First Nations, Métis, and/or Inuit world views and aspirations, and design an effective initiative to build mutual understanding and cultural awareness (e.g., *a series of sharing circles in school for youth, cultural facilitators, and community members to exchange ideas about Indigenous realities and cultural diversity; a multimedia presentation and/or pamphlet to offer approaches to cultural awareness; an art exhibition or other cultural event about historical and/or contemporary issues related to a First Nation, Métis, or Inuit community*)

**Sample questions:** “Why should all Canadians be educated about First Nations, Métis, and Inuit realities? How can improving your own and your peers’ understanding of Indigenous histories, current realities, and cultural protocols help change relationships between Indigenous and non-Indigenous individuals in Canada?” “How might you encourage your classmates to learn about local Indigenous realities and build their cultural awareness skills?” “What could you do to engage your class in learning about the successes and challenges that First Nations, Métis, or Inuit communities experience? How might you respectfully engage local First Nations, Métis, or Inuit individuals and/or a local community in these efforts?”

# C. COLONIZATION AND DECOLONIZATION

## OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1. Colonialism and Colonization:** demonstrate an understanding of the concept of colonialism, and of the past and present impact of colonization and related government policies in Canada;
- C2. Decolonization, Resilience, and Social Change:** demonstrate an understanding of the key concepts and goals of decolonization and resilience, analysing various strategies to raise awareness of the impact of colonialist policies and to sustain First Nations, Métis, and Inuit world views, aspirations, and actions in the context of social change.

## SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

### C1. Colonialism and Colonization

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1.1** explain the significance for First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities and cultures of the key concepts associated with colonialism (e.g., *the doctrine of discovery and the concept of terra nullius were used by Europeans as justification to declare right and supremacy over the new world and forcibly displace many First Nations communities; assimilationist policies separated First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals from their families, communities, and the land; the European religious “civilizing mission” led to the repression and near extinction of Indigenous spiritual and cultural practices, languages, and knowledge*), identifying some connections between these concepts

**Sample questions:** “How are the doctrine of discovery and the concept of *terra nullius* connected?” “How does *terra nullius* infringe on Indigenous peoples’ relationships with the land?” “How are the concepts of paternalism and colonialism linked?” “What was the ‘civilizing mission’ in Canada? What were some of its effects? How is the civilizing mission related to assimilationist policy?” “What do the establishment of the Métis provisional government in 1869 and the List of Rights that the provisional government issued tell you about the Métis approach to dealing with colonialism? What colonialist concepts did the List of Rights address?”

- C1.2** analyse a variety of government policies and actions in Canada to determine their role with respect to assimilation and their impact on First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals, communities, world views, and aspirations (e.g., *the Gradual Civilization Act of 1857 made Indian status for women conditional on marital status, causing many to lose community connections and imposing a patrilineal system on some matrilineal cultures; the Gradual Enfranchisement Act of 1869 restricted the power of band councils, weakening the governance practices of First Nations communities; the Indian Act prohibited various traditional practices and introduced other provisions that collectively undermined community values and jeopardized the survival of communities; residential school policy forbade students to engage in cultural practices or speak Indigenous languages, interrupting intergenerational cultural transmission and instilling mistrust of institutional learning*)

**Sample questions:** “Do you think that the slaughter of thousands of Arctic sled dogs by the RCMP and other authorities enforcing animal control laws was an assimilationist policy? Why, or why not?” “How did the enfranchisement policies outlined in the Indian Act of 1867 affect First Nations individuals? What connection can you make between enfranchisement and assimilation?” “What assimilationist provision of the Indian Act did Sandra Lovelace Nicholas seek to have amended in *Sandra Lovelace v. Canada*, 1977–81? What social and economic consequences did her lawsuit have, and how are these consequences related to First Nations aspirations?”

**C1.3** analyse the use of political and judicial systems in Canada to enforce colonialist approaches to the ownership, development, and management of land and natural resources (*e.g., with reference to the extinguishment of title through the distribution of land scrip to Métis individuals, the forced relocation of Inuit from northern Quebec to the High Arctic, specific and comprehensive land claims, court cases, treaties*), suggesting some ways in which these approaches have affected First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities

**Sample questions:** “In what ways are current approaches to land management and ownership in Canada related to colonialism and colonization? What are some consequences for First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities?” “Why did the issue of an Aboriginal right to fish come before the court in *R. v. Sparrow*, 1990? How was the case related to colonialist policies, and what did the subsequent ruling confirm?” “In what ways did the Community Pasture Program in Manitoba disregard Métis community knowledge and aspirations? What connections can you make to colonialism? How has the program affected life for the Métis people?”

## C2. Decolonization, Resilience, and Social Change

By the end of this course, students will:

**C2.1** explain the significance for Indigenous and non-Indigenous individuals in Canada of the key concepts and goals associated with decolonization and resilience in the context of social change (*e.g., societal acceptance of responsibility for the continuing consequences of colonization enables First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals to feel understood and respected; consultations to develop new political and social policies encourage Indigenous community members to participate in societal change; incorporating First Nations, Métis, and Inuit perspectives into contemporary public institutions gives Indigenous citizens a voice in Canadian society; learning about the goals of decolonization helps both Indigenous and non-Indigenous individuals understand the history of Canada and all its peoples; improving educational attainment supports First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individual and community aspirations and addresses inequality of opportunity; revitalizing Indigenous languages supports individual and collective cultural identity*)

**Sample questions:** “What are some specific ways in which Indigenous and non-Indigenous individuals can address the consequences of

colonization? How do their roles in this effort differ? How are they similar? How do these decolonization efforts affect the lives of both Indigenous and non-Indigenous individuals? Why are these efforts important?” “Why do you think the term ‘resilience’ is used in the context of the legacy of colonization? In what ways does exploring current decolonization efforts by First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals and communities enhance your understanding of the impact of colonization and your appreciation of Indigenous resilience?”

**C2.2** analyse several different initiatives to raise awareness of the continuing impact of colonialist policies in Canada in terms of the motivations, methods, and results of these efforts (*e.g., with reference to processes and consultations with Indigenous governments to address issues related to child welfare, education, justice, economic opportunity and fairness, environmental protection, political representation, health; social media movements and campaigns; public art projects that advocate for social justice; forms of protest and resilience such as teach-ins, fasts, demonstrations, and blockades; legal action*)

**Sample questions:** “What beliefs, values, and aspirations motivated the establishment of the Idle No More movement? How do these motivations influence the actions of the movement? What similarities and differences can you identify between grassroots responses to the movement across Canada and media portrayals of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit realities? How do you explain any differences?” “What legal action did Cindy Blackstock take in order to raise awareness of discrimination against First Nations children in Canada? What was the outcome? Why is support still needed for change?” “What role did the Truth and Reconciliation Commission of Canada have in giving a voice to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit residential school survivors and their families?” “How did the *R v. Powley* and *R v. Laurin, Lemieux and Lemieux* cases raise awareness of the continuing effect of colonialist policy on Métis in Ontario?”

**C2.3** analyse several different First Nations, Métis, and Inuit initiatives to assert community control over local economic development and land use in terms of the motivations and methods of different stakeholders involved in these actions (*e.g., with reference to road blocks and land occupations, the creation of community development corporations, the inclusion of training and recruitment parameters within economic development agreements*)

**Sample questions:** “What concerns do some First Nations communities have about the Ring of Fire mining project in northern Ontario, and how have these communities attempted to address these concerns? Have constitutionally protected Aboriginal and treaty rights been honoured and protected as this project developed? What beliefs and values can you identify in the positions of the communities, land developers, and governments involved in the project? How do these beliefs and values correspond and/or conflict? How might a peaceful resolution be achieved?” “What issues related to land and natural resources was the Métis Betterment Act intended to address? What challenges did the Métis and the province of Alberta face in working within the partnership created by the Act? What were some benefits?”

**C2.4** analyse several different First Nations, Métis, and Inuit initiatives to address language loss to determine how these initiatives support traditional values and community aspirations (e.g., with reference to *using language nests, using digital technology to teach language, introducing apprenticeship programs to encourage language revitalization, supporting local school boards in offering language programs, developing language programs in on-reserve schools, establishing language acquisition as a priority in community planning and development*)

**Sample questions:** “What are some benefits of offering immersion classes in an Indigenous language in a First Nation, Métis, or Inuit community?” “How do language nests support traditional values?” “What connections can you make between language preservation and cultural resilience?” “How does a unified writing system support Inuit language and cultural revitalization?” “For decades, Michif has been labelled as ‘broken’ French. How has that perception influenced use of the language? What strategies are being used to foster a better understanding of the Michif language? How might this support Métis aspirations?”

**C2.5** analyse a variety of forms and uses of contemporary technology, media, and popular culture (e.g., *graphic novels, photography, social media, music, digital and print magazines*) in terms of how they support and/or promote First Nations, Métis, and Inuit knowledge, world views, aspirations, and actions in the context of social change

**Sample questions:** “What role do you think Indigenous journalists have in drawing attention to murdered and missing Indigenous women and girls in Canada? How have Indigenous and non-Indigenous communities responded?” “Why do you think *Red Rising Magazine* refers to itself as a movement? How do its digital and print media complement each other? How does this use of technology support First Nations aspirations?” “How does the work of film-maker Alanis Obomsawin embody the goals of decolonization?” “What examples can you find of youth using social media to support or promote Métis world views? In your opinion, are their actions an example of social change or of cultural continuity? What evidence can you provide?”

## D. RECLAMATION AND RECONCILIATION

### OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- D1. Reclaiming Traditional Beliefs, Values, and Customs:** demonstrate an understanding of how individuals, families, institutions, and communities are reclaiming a place for First Nations, Métis, and Inuit beliefs, values, and customs in contemporary life;
- D2. Truth, Reconciliation, and Renewal:** demonstrate an understanding of how building recognition and respect for First Nations, Métis, and Inuit knowledge, world views, and aspirations contributes to truth, reconciliation, and renewed nation-to-nation relationships;
- D3. Aspirations and Social Action:** demonstrate an understanding of how key First Nations, Métis, and Inuit aspirations for communities, for Canada, and for global society reflect traditional and contemporary beliefs and values, and analyse the role of social action in supporting those goals.

### SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

#### D1. Reclaiming Traditional Beliefs, Values, and Customs

By the end of this course, students will:

- D1.1** explain the purpose and function of several different individual roles associated with First Nations, Métis, and Inuit beliefs, values, and customs (*e.g., oshkaabewisag are messengers or assistants who oversee communication with a council and help enforce council decisions; Senators share traditions and ways of life to keep Métis culture alive; Inuit midwives perform the tuqurausiq naming practice that links a newborn Inuk to a relative or deceased family friend*), and analyse the impact of a variety of strategies to ensure the continued importance of these roles in the community (*e.g., with reference to hosting community circles and conferences for Elders and knowledge keepers to share teachings with community members; developing and supporting traditional healing programs; making and archiving recordings of Elders sharing stories, knowledge, and experience; including cultural protocols and practices in community governance*)

**Sample questions:** “What distinctive roles do First Nations, Métis, and Inuit women have within the family, in governance structures, and in ceremonies? What strategies are First Nations, Métis, and Inuit women using to reclaim these roles? What are some results of these efforts?” “What value is added to strategic planning meetings between First Nations,

Métis, or Inuit groups and non-Indigenous groups when Elders and/or knowledge keepers participate?”

- D1.2** analyse several different strategies to integrate traditional knowledge and customs into contemporary life for First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals and communities to identify benefits and challenges related to these efforts (*e.g., benefits: providing some community schools and offices with the opportunity to offer cultural leave enables Indigenous youth and adults to maintain their cultural identity by participating in traditional customs; supporting the use of traditional medicines, knowledge, and health practices as part of a comprehensive approach to health care for urban Indigenous individuals can improve physical and psychological well-being; challenges: individuals who seek cultural knowledge or wish to learn a language based on their ancestry may have insufficient access to relevant programming; mainstream institutions may find it difficult to accommodate cultural leave related to seasonal activities; traditional hunting practices may conflict with non-Indigenous approaches to animal rights and/or animal husbandry*)

**Sample questions:** “What benefits does the ‘goose break’ continue to have for Cree communities in northern Quebec and Ontario?” “What are some benefits and challenges related to providing Indigenous liaison roles in hospitals to support health and wellness practices?” “How does Alethea Arnaquq-Baril’s film

*Angry Inuk* help you understand the benefits of the traditional seal hunt and the challenges that Inuit face in continuing the hunt? In what ways do the opinions of Inuit hunters and animal rights activists diverge? Do they have any common ground?" "What are some differences between recreational/sport fishing and fishing under harvesting rights? Why do Indigenous harvesting rights continue to be important, and what efforts are being made to assert these rights?"

**D1.3** analyse a variety of programs and initiatives to reclaim a place for First Nations, Métis, and Inuit beliefs, values, and customs in education in Canada to identify benefits and suggest ways to address challenges related to implementation (e.g., with reference to *Elder-in-residence programs at educational institutions; partnerships between arts organizations and local Indigenous artists/groups, such as the Ontario Arts Council Indigenous Artists in Schools program to offer arts workshops in schools; the inclusion of Indigenous knowledge in environmental studies and science education*)

**Sample questions:** "What are some benefits and challenges involved in offering Indigenous language programs in place of French as a second language in elementary or secondary schools? How might school boards and communities address the challenges?" "What strategies might postsecondary Indigenous student centres and programs use to support student success and engagement? What barriers remain to student success and how might they be overcome?" "In what ways does the Gabriel Dumont Institute of Native Studies and Applied Research support education and the renewal of Métis culture? What results has it had?" "What sort of educational programming does the Manitobah Mukluks Storyboot School offer? How does this demonstrate an act of cultural revitalization?"

## D2. Truth, Reconciliation, and Renewal

By the end of this course, students will:

**D2.1** analyse a variety of cultural observances/events in terms of their contribution to truth, reconciliation, and renewal related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit traditional knowledge and customs (e.g., *the Back to Batoche Festival celebrates and promotes understanding of Métis culture; the Arctic Winter Games build awareness of the values of Inuit and other northern cultures by facilitating social, cultural, and economic exchange among circumpolar communities; First Nations vigils provide opportunities for cooperative organization and shared knowledge building*)

**Sample questions:** "How do seasonal gatherings of communities belonging to the same culture

help families understand traditional knowledge and customs? What other purposes do such gatherings have?" "How does an Indigenous arts festival, such as the ImagineNATIVE Film & Media Arts Festival, help change misconceptions about First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities and cultures?"

**D2.2** analyse a variety of efforts to promote First Nations, Métis, and Inuit environmental knowledge and perspectives in terms of their contribution to truth, reconciliation, and renewal related to the land (e.g., *the 2015 Sacred Water Walk promoted understanding of the connection between people and the land by raising awareness of oil spills and train derailments that have caused harm to the Great Lakes and St Lawrence River; teach-ins hosted by Indigenous movements such as Idle No More offer grassroots perspectives on environmental protection; environmental scientists who draw on Inuit observations of changes in climate and/or biodiversity in the Arctic raise awareness of the value of Indigenous ecological knowledge*), making inferences about the beliefs and values that motivate these actions

**Sample questions:** "How do Indigenous environmental studies and science programs help postsecondary students prepare for work with Indigenous communities in the field of environmental protection? What values underlie this work?" "In what ways have Indigenous-led organizations incorporated various ways of knowing into their work on environmental justice and Indigenous rights? How has this contributed to truth, reconciliation, and renewal?"

**D2.3** analyse the impact on both Indigenous and non-Indigenous individuals in Canada of various government policies and actions intended to affirm truth, reconciliation, and renewal related to decolonization (e.g., *the Ipperwash Inquiry brought attention to police negligence and political bias, culminating in the return of disputed territory; the creation of Nunavut facilitated a consensus approach to self-governance, restoring Inuit values and traditions to the political process; Canada's statement of support for the United Nations Declaration on the Rights of Indigenous Peoples affirms the commitment of the Canadian state to promoting and protecting the rights of Indigenous peoples around the world*)

**Sample questions:** "How has the consensus approach to governance in Nunavut brought attention to Inuit knowledge, world views, and aspirations?" "How has the formal apology by the Canadian federal government to former students of Indian residential schools affected non-Indigenous attitudes towards assimilation and diversity? What consequences has the

apology had for residential school survivors?” “How does the tripartite memorandum of understanding between the Métis Nation of Ontario, the government of Canada, and the province of Ontario advance self-governance and reconciliation?”

**D2.4** analyse the impact on both Indigenous and non-Indigenous individuals in Canada of various judicial/legal actions intended to affirm truth, reconciliation, and renewal regarding Aboriginal title, treaty rights, and nation-to-nation relationships (*e.g., court actions to protect Aboriginal fishing rights substantiate treaty obligations in law; the Canadian Charter of Rights and Freedoms precludes the use of the charter to diminish existing Aboriginal rights; the Nunavut Land Claims Agreement is dedicated to achieving Inuit social, cultural, and economic well-being through its implementation*)

**Sample questions:** “How do cases such as *Mikisew Cree First Nation v. Canada*, 2005, build understanding and acceptance of First Nations rights related to treaty relationships and traditional land use? In your opinion, how has the case affected public perceptions of these values? How might this case affect land claims in Ontario?” “How did *Delgamuukw v. British Columbia*, 1997, change the way oral history is viewed in terms of historical evidence about Aboriginal title?” “What are some implications of the Nunavut Land Claims Agreement for reconciliation? Do you think the agreement supports a nation-to-nation relationship? Why, or why not?” “How does section 35 of the Constitution Act, 1982, set the stage for advancing reconciliation between First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals and communities and Canadian society?”

### D3. Aspirations and Social Action

By the end of this course, students will:

**D3.1** analyse a variety of aspirations that First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals and organizations characterize as important for communities, for Canada, and for global society (*e.g., for communities: truth telling and healing, educational autonomy, economic prosperity, access to clean water; for Canada: reconciliation and justice, the sustainable use of natural resources, the inclusion of Indigenous peoples as equal partners in social and political decision making; for global society: respect for the rights of Indigenous peoples around the world; recognition for the distinct identities of Indigenous communities; global planning for seven generations; the establishment of advisory committees to inform programming on issues*

*related to Indigenous peoples, such as sovereignty/self-governance and self-determination*) in terms of how these aspirations reflect Indigenous knowledge and world views and promote renewed relationships

**Sample questions:** “In what ways are governments and Inuit community-based organizations working together to support the aspiration of improved access to mental health services? How do these efforts reflect Inuit values?” “How do the calls to action expressed in the *Final Report of the Truth and Reconciliation Commission of Canada* reflect First Nations, Métis, and Inuit aspirations and world views? What are some specific ways in which the report encourages renewed relationships based on mutual understanding and respect?” “How are the environmental aspirations of Indigenous peoples in Canada and in other countries similar? How do they reflect Indigenous knowledge and world views? What benefits might there be in considering these perspectives in efforts to address climate change?”

**D3.2** interpret and explain the goals of a variety of social initiatives to support First Nations, Métis, and Inuit aspirations (*e.g., with reference to Shannen’s Dream campaign for equitable funding and culturally based education for First Nations children and youth; programs, resources, and funding offered through Inspire to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals; Ontario Arts Council awards and fellowships for emerging and established First Nations, Métis, and Inuit artists; scholarships, bursaries, and financial literacy resources provided by banking institutions; entrepreneurship programs for Indigenous women*), and analyse their achievements and continuing challenges

**Sample questions:** “What are the goals of this partnership between a health network and an urban Indigenous community? What obstacles and supports has the partnership experienced? Has the partnership achieved its goals? What evidence can you offer?” “What challenges do First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities still face with respect to mental health crisis management? How might these challenges be better addressed?” “What specific resources and funding are available to Indigenous youth and women to start a business?” “What programs has the Métis Nation of Ontario developed in order to address Métis aspirations with respect to academic and skills development? What are some of their achievements?” “How are colleges and universities re-examining the ways in which they are delivering education to Indigenous students in response to the calls to action of the Truth and Reconciliation Commission of Canada?”